

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣7

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦J

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥3

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 3

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K 10

♣ 10 9 2

♠ K J 7 2

♥ A 7 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 6 5 3



♠ 9 6

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ Q J 8 7

♠ A Q

♥ K Q J 2

♦ A Q 9 8

♣ A K 4

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

NORTH has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

SOUTH figures NORTH for 8 points and bids 6NT. If NORTH has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♣7			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 8 2

♥ A 5

♦ A K 2

♣ A K 2

♠ A 9 6 5

♥ 10 9 7 4

♦ Q 5 3

♣ Q 3



♠ 7

♥ K Q J 8 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 8 7 4

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 6

♦ J 10 7 4

♣ J 10 9 6 5

WEST opens 2♣ and EAST, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

WEST should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And EAST can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for WEST to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

West

2♣

2♠

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Lead: ♦J

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♥

3♥

South

Pass

Pass

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ J 10 6 3
 ♦ 9 8 4
 ♣ J 10 8 4 2

♠ K Q 8 7
 ♥ A K Q 2
 ♦ A K J 6
 ♣ 6



♠ 9 6 4 2
 ♥ 9 7 4
 ♦ 10 5 3
 ♣ A 9 7

♠ A J 10 5
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ Q 7 2
 ♣ K Q 5 3

After NORTH's 2♣ opening, SOUTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. SOUTH actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

NORTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking SOUTH for a 4-card Major. SOUTH mentions his ♠s and NORTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now SOUTH adds his 12 points to NORTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 6 3
♥ A K 10 9 6
♦ 10 6
♣ A

♠ 10 9 8 7
♥ 7 3
♦ Q 5 4
♣ K Q 9 4



♠ 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ 9 8 7 2
♣ 10 7 6 3

♠ J 5 4
♥ 8 4
♦ A K J 3
♣ J 8 5 2

EAST has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when WEST bids 2♠.

However, when WEST then bids ♥s, EAST finds two more points and bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	

All Pass
4♥ by West
Lead: ♥3